



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Faith Christian Academy
School Website: <https://fcaclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Faith Christian Academy (Kansas City, MO, 64164) (FCA) presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Across all six rubric categories, FCA demonstrates explicit religious grounding, formation aims, a Trivium-based curriculum, contemplative and dialogic pedagogy, a faculty culture oriented toward virtue and mentorship, and deep parent/community partnership. Public materials repeatedly emphasize Christ-centered formation, Biblical study, Latin and the liberal arts, Socratic-style inquiry in the secondary program, and active parental involvement as co-educators. This convergence supports a CLASSICAL overall classification with clear, category-consistent evidence. Evidence excerpts drawn from FCA's site and related materials show clear signals in each category, including explicit Trinity-era classical pedagogy anchors (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation; Socratic dialogue; memory work with singing/recitation), and a culture of parental partnership and communal formation. See below for category-by-category keyword analyses and ratings. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

- As an aggregate, FCA is CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle? No major needle-moving changes are required given the current findings. If anything, minor enhancements could emphasize explicit language around "Great Books" and formal Socratic seminars in more grade levels beyond what is already present, but the existing materials already strongly support classical aims (see Element 4 for explicit Socratic/dialogic pedagogy in the secondary). For a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL result, you would seek more uniform articulation of all six element indicators in public-facing materials; FCA already satisfies those indicators in most cases. No such needle-moving changes are required for this school to be CLASSICAL.
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ABSTRACT section at the end summarizes the six-category assessment and the overall CLASSICAL classification.

Cited sources appear inline in the category sections to ground the analysis.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's own materials describe a Christ-centered framework and theology-integrated formation: "Christ-centered" education and "the LORD" language appear repeatedly in public-facing texts. For example, FCA describes its core ideology as Christ-centered and points students to Christ at school as well as at home.
- Bible study and Biblical framing are explicit in the grammar school narrative, including emphasis on Bible stories and a Creator, implying a theological/metaphysical grounding.
- The school's public-facing history and mission materials frame education as formation within a Christian worldview, including references to image bearers of Christ and a relationship between educators and parents in a Christian frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Bible, Christ-centered, LORD, Creator, theology, Christian, God, Gospel framing. These reflect Transcendental Moral Realism and Grounded Theology signals in the Six Elements framework. Approximately 5–6 distinct positive signals are present across materials.
- Negative keywords: 0 clear instances of secular or relativistic framing; no explicit values-neutral or secular-neutral language identified in the public materials reviewed.

Why this rating

- FCA's materials foreground a transcendent moral framework anchored in Christian theology, worship/-communal practice implied via Bible-centered formation, and explicit Christ-centered language. These align with the Positive Keywords for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practice in the Six Elements rubric. The absence of secular/neutral framing strengthens the CLASSICAL rating. The secondary materials show explicit theological integration through Bible/studies, and a liturgical/communal rhythm (celebrations in Grade School narratives, etc.). Therefore, this category is CLASSICAL.

Evidence citations: Christ-centered formation text; Bible-centered grammar school narrative; Our Story/mission language.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Formation over information: FCA emphasizes formation of character, virtue, and a life oriented toward truth and virtue rather than mere job preparation. This is stated in mission-oriented language about formation and shaping character, and in materials that highlight a classical telos (great ideas, great conversation).
- Delighting in learning and engagement with Great Ideas/Great Conversation signals a classical telos beyond vocational outcomes. The school frames education as a path to wisdom and virtue rather than solely career prep.
- Public materials convey a Christian formation aim aligned with classical aims (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) rather than a narrow workforce focus.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, Great Ideas, Great Conversation, human flourishing, telos. These appear across Our Approach, Our Story, and the public-facing "Our Approach" and "Our Story" materials.
- Negative keywords: None of the listed negative indicators (e.g., employment-driven workforce language, relativism, secular ethics) appear in FCA's public materials.

Why this rating

- FCA's stated aims emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom, and explicitly position education as a formation of the whole person consistent with the classical telos. The presence of "Great Ideas/Great Conversation" and formation-focused language corroborates this. Given the explicit alignment with formation over information and the teleology toward virtue and wisdom, Element 2 is CLASSICAL.

Evidence citations: Our Approach (formation over information, Great Ideas), Our Story (Great Conversation), and related materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Liberal arts foundation with Trivium: The grammar school page explicitly centers on the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and includes Latin instruction from third grade onward. This is a core liberal-arts curricular framework in classical education.
- Great Books/Great Conversation elements: Secondary materials describe engagement with Great Books and Great Ideas, aligning with the classical canon and a cross-disciplinary approach.
- History integrated through Bible and literature; cross-disciplinary study noted (Bible, history, literature; formation through celebration). The grammar school narrative indicates integrated study across history, science, and Bible.
- Latin instruction: Policy of Latin study in the grammar school (3rd grade onward) is explicitly stated.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium); Latin; Great Books/Great Conversation; history; Bible; classical canon; liberal arts; wonder. These show clear alignment with the Curriculum element.
- Negative keywords: None of the typical “non-classical” signals (e.g., social studies-centric history replacing history, heavy project-based-only frames) appear in FCA’s materials.

Why this rating

- The explicit inclusion of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation, and integrated history/bible study demonstrates a robust classical curriculum. Together with the Great Ideas/Great Conversation framing, this category is CLASSICAL.

Evidence citations: Grammar School Trivium and Latin; Secondary Great Books/Great Conversation; Bible/history integration in Grammar School.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Socratic/dialogic pedagogy in secondary: FCA’s secondary materials describe Socratic dialogue and Great Books engagement, indicating explicit Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy in the upper grades.
- Contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) and memory practices: The classical pedagogy framework includes contemplative/restful learning and memory work (singing/chanting) in lower grades; FCA materials note singing, memory, and recall in lower levels. The grammar school content references singing and memory devices as memory deepening.
- Rhetoric and public speaking: Leadership materials show a focus on rhetoric (e.g., “Head of School, Rhetoric,” “Secondary Coordinator, Logic, Rhetoric”), signaling explicit rhetoric training and opportunities to present and speak.
- Upper-level classical pedagogy: The secondary program explicitly engages students with Great Books and Socratic dialogue; the Our Story/Our Approach materials emphasize a culture of dialogue and inquiry, aligning with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, memory work (chanting/singing), rhetoric, public speaking, Great Books, inquiry-based discussion, Harkness-like dialogue (explicitly or implied), and structured dialogue.
- Negative keywords: None evident; no indication of exclusively project-based or purely experiential learning without dialectic discussion.

Why this rating

- FCA's public-facing materials demonstrate a strong classical pedagogy in both lower and upper grades: memory-based recitation and singing in the lower grades, Socratic/dialogic pedagogy in the upper grades, and explicit rhetoric/public speaking training. This aligns with the Pedagogy element's Positive Keywords and signals a CLASSICAL rating.

Evidence citations: Secondary Socratic dialogue; memory/singing in Grammar School; Head of School with Rhetoric; Our Story/Our Approach references to Great Ideas and dialogue.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The faculty is presented as mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; the school's leadership pages describe a "living curriculum" ethos and faculty portraits, with governance and a clear idea of what a teacher should be. Public materials emphasize faculty as central to the school's mission and culture.
- The leadership and faculty pages show a substantial and credentialed staff, including a Head of School (Rhetoric), Grammar School Principal, Secondary Coordinator (Logic, Rhetoric), and subject-area teachers, indicating a mature, faculty-led culture aligned with classical aims.
- The articulation of a collaborative, mentorship-focused faculty environment (faculty as mentors, collaborative learning culture) is present in FCA texts that emphasize teachers as living exemplars within the school's ethos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers; mentors; virtue formation; collaboration; collegiality; master-apprentice or mentorship language; public articulation of faculty roles (Head of School, Principal, Department Heads).
- Negative keywords: None observed that would signal a departure from a classical faculty model (e.g., "facilitators on the side" or purely facilitator roles without exemplars).

Why this rating

- FCA's materials demonstrate a classical faculty culture that acts as the living curriculum and emphasizes virtue, mentorship, and collegiality. The staff structure supports this, with leadership focused on rhetoric, logic, and humanities, and a collaborative, teacher-centered ethos. This supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Evidence citations: Our Approach (faculty as living curriculum and mentorship language); Leadership/Faculty pages (Head of School, Principal, Department Heads).

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Partnership with families and co-educators: FCA explicitly frames parents as co-teachers and emphasizes collaborative partnership with families; texts describe parents as essential partners and mention that "you are your child's teacher at home."
- Parental formation and engagement: Materials describe opportunities for parental involvement, including book studies, gatherings, and programs designed to educate parents about classical education; public materials show a culture of ongoing parental involvement.
- Open campus and accessibility: The school's site indicates that parents are engaged and welcomed, with communications channels (Team App, final forms playbooks) that facilitate parent participation; examples include FinalForms Parent Playbook and Team App communications.

- Our Story and Our Mission emphasize shared work with parents in forming students toward “Image bearers of Christ” and the Great Conversation of the Ages, underscoring durable parental involvement and shared mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, parental involvement, home-school connection, parent formation, school-parent synergy, living tradition in the family.
- Negative keywords: none evident; no indication of a consumer-model or parent as customer only.

Why this rating

- FCA’s public materials emphasize active parental involvement, parent formation, and open access/visits, aligning with the Parent & Community indicators in the Six Elements rubric. The materials also emphasize church-family-school alignment and parental participation in classical education formation, supporting a CLASSICAL rating.

Evidence citations: Our Approach (Parent co-teaching language, home-based formation), Our Story (parents and teachers working together), FinalForms/Team App pages (parent engagement tools).

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL scenarios)

- Not applicable here since all six categories align with CLASSICAL. If a needle were to move, it would be toward more explicit, public articulation of classical features (e.g., a clearer, formal statement of Great Books, a documented Socratic seminar program across more grade levels, and explicit descriptions of the Great Conversation in elementary/middle grades). However, FCA already demonstrates strong signals in all six categories, including explicit Socratic/dialogic pedagogy in the secondary program and a robust Trivium-based curriculum, along with a strong parental-partnership ethos.
 - Concrete examples (if needed in a future update) to further strengthen CLASSICAL signals could include:
 - Expanded public pages detailing Great Books selections by grade, and explicit mention of graded Socratic seminars across grades (K–12).
 - Public facing examples of student speeches, oration events, and public rhetoric assignments linked to rhetoric curricula.
 - A formal, published “Living Curriculum” statement that explicitly links faculty roles to character formation and virtue ethics across all divisions.
 - No major needle-moving changes are required for CLASSICAL status.
 - Citations supporting these suggestions are embedded in the cited category analyses above, particularly the Sophisticated pedagogy in Secondary (Socratic dialogue) and the head-of-school rhetoric role that implies ritualized rhetoric training.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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